GLOSSARY

Glossary

Every musical word in the Handbook, in one line, with the page where it is explained.

8va (ottava) play the notes under the dotted line an octave higher p.36

a tempo back to the speed before p.82

accelerando (accel.) gradually faster p.82

accent a > over a note: start it more strongly p.79

acciaccatura a tiny note with a slash, crushed in as fast as possible p.88

accidental a sharp, flat or natural written before a note; it lasts until the bar line p.39

Adagio slow, at ease p.82

Alberti bass a broken chord in the left hand: low, high, middle, high (C G E G) p.152

Allegro fast and lively p.82

anacrusis an upbeat: notes before the first full bar p.65

Andante at a walking pace p.82

appoggiatura a tiny note without a slash; it leans, taking half the main note's time p.88

articulation how notes are joined or separated: slurs, staccato, tenuto, accents p.79

augmented triad a triad with 3 + 3 keys between p.113

bar a group of beats between two bar lines p.50

Baroque music of about 1600–1750: Bach, Handel p.159

bass clef the F clef: its two dots hug the line for bass F p.27

beam a thick line joining quavers or semiquavers into a beat p.65

beat the steady pulse you count p.50

binary form two sections, A B p.156

broken chord the notes of a chord played one after another p.142

cadence the last two chords of a phrase: musical punctuation p.139

cantabile in a singing style p.79

chord three or more notes played together p.110

circle of fifths the keys in a circle: go right, one more sharp; go left, one more flat p.105

Classical music of about 1750–1820: Haydn, Mozart p.159

clef the sign at the start of the staff that names one line p.27

coda an ending section; jump to it at "To Coda" p.71

compound time each beat is a dotted note and divides into three (6/8, 9/8, 12/8) p.62

crescendo (cresc.) getting louder, little by little p.76

crotchet a note worth one beat in 4/4 p.53

da capo (D.C.) "from the head": go back to the beginning p.71

dal segno (D.S.) "from the sign": go back to the segno p.71

diminished triad a triad with 2 + 2 keys between p.113

diminuendo (dim.) getting softer, little by little p.76

dolce sweetly p.79

dominant the 5th note of the scale, and the chord built on it (V) p.116

dot adds half the note's value p.56

duplet two notes in the time of three p.65

dynamics the signs for loud and soft: pp p mp mf f ff p.76

GLOSSARY · CONTINUED

enharmonic two names for one key, such as F♯ and G♭ p.39

fermata a pause: hold the note longer than written p.82

Fine "the end": after a D.C. or D.S., stop here p.71

five-finger position one finger on each of five keys in a row p.163

flat (♭) the very next key to the left p.39

form the plan of a whole piece, in letters p.156

forte (f) loud p.76

grand staff treble and bass staves joined by a brace p.27

hairpin a crescendo or diminuendo sign that opens or closes p.76

hemiola two bars of three felt as three bars of two p.68

homophonic a tune with chords underneath p.152

imitation another hand or voice copies the idea p.150

interval the distance between two notes p.42

inversion a chord with a note other than the root at the bottom p.119

key the scale a piece is built on, and its home note p.99

key signature the sharps or flats at the start of every line p.99

Largo very slow and broad p.82

leading note the 7th note of the scale, one key below home p.93

ledger line a short line for a note above or below the staff p.36

legato smoothly joined p.79

major scale tone, tone, semitone, tone, tone, tone, semitone p.93

major triad a triad with 3 + 2 keys between p.113

metronome mark ♩ = 76: 76 beats in a minute p.82

mezzo (m) "half": mp half soft, mf half loud p.76

Middle C the C nearest the middle of the keyboard, on a ledger line between the staves p.22

minim a note worth two crotchets p.53

minor scale the major scale on the same note with 3, 6 and 7 one key lower p.96

minor triad a triad with 2 + 3 keys between p.113

Moderato at a moderate speed p.82

modulation changing key during a piece p.154

monophonic one line alone p.152

mordent the note, its neighbour above (or below), the note p.88

motif a short idea of 2 to 6 notes that comes back p.148

natural (♮) cancels a sharp or flat p.39

octave from one note to the next of the same name: 11 keys between p.45

ornament a small sign for a quick group of notes around the main note p.88

pedal (sustain) the right pedal: notes keep ringing until you lift it p.85

perfect cadence V to I: a full stop p.139

phrase a musical sentence, often 4 bars p.148

pianissimo (pp) very soft p.76

piano (p) soft p.76

plagal cadence IV to I: the "Amen" p.139

polyphonic two or more tunes at once p.152

Presto very fast p.82

progression a trip from chord to chord p.144

pulse the steady beat underneath the music p.50

quaver half a crotchet p.53

GLOSSARY · CONTINUED

rallentando (rall.) gradually slower p.82

relative minor the minor key with the same key signature, a minor 3rd below p.96

repeat sign two dots and a double bar: play the bars again p.71

rest a silence of a set length p.53

ritardando (rit.) gradually slower p.82

Romantic music of about 1820–1900: Chopin, Schumann p.159

rondo A B A C A: the first idea keeps coming back p.156

root the note a chord is built on and named after p.110

rubato time stretched and given back, for expression p.68

scale the notes of a key in order, up or down p.93

semibreve a whole note: four crotchets p.53

semiquaver half a quaver p.53

semitone the very next key: no key between p.22

sequence the same shape repeated higher or lower p.150

seventh chord a triad with one more 3rd on top p.122

sforzando (sfz) one note made suddenly strong p.76

sharp (♯) the very next key to the right p.39

sight-reading playing music at first sight p.167

simple time each beat divides into two (2/4, 3/4, 4/4) p.59

slash chord C/E: the chord, then the bass note p.131

slur a curve over different notes: join them p.79

staccato a dot: short, detached p.79

staff the five lines and four spaces music is written on p.27

subdominant the 4th note of the scale, and the chord built on it (IV) p.116

swing pairs of quavers played long–short p.68

syncopation the stress falls off the beat p.68

tempo the speed of the beat p.50

tenuto a line: hold the note its full length p.79

ternary form A B A: out, away and back p.156

texture how many lines sound at once, and how they fit p.152

theme and variations one tune, changed each time it returns p.156

tie a curve joining two notes of the same pitch: one longer sound p.56

time signature top: how many beats; bottom: which note gets one beat p.59

tone two semitones: one key between p.22

tonic the 1st note of the scale: home p.93

treble clef the G clef: it curls round the line for treble G p.27

triad three notes stacked: play one, skip one, play one p.110

trill the note and its neighbour above, back and forth quickly p.88

triplet three notes in the time of two p.65

turn above, the note, below, the note p.88

twelve-bar blues I I I I · IV IV I I · V IV I I p.144

una corda (u.c.) the left (soft) pedal p.85

upbeat see anacrusis p.65

INDEX

Index

Where each word appears. The first page is where it is explained.

8va (ottava) 36, 38
a tempo 82, 83
accelerando (accel.) 82, 83
accent 79
acciaccatura 88, 89
accidental 39, 155
Adagio 82
Alberti bass 143, 152, 159, 160
Allegro 82
anacrusis 65, 66
Andante 82
appoggiatura 88, 89
arpeggio 110, 111
articulation 79
augmented triad 113
bar 50, 51, 53, 55, 56
Baroque 156, 159, 160
bass clef 27
beam 53, 65
beat 50, 51, 52, 54, 56
binary form 156
block chords 152
borrowed chord 136
broken chord 142, 152
C clef 27
cadence 139, 140, 146
cantabile 79, 81
chord 110, 111, 113, 116, 117
circle of fifths 105
Classical 159, 160
clef 27, 34, 48
coda 71, 73
common time 59, 60
compound time 62
crescendo (cresc.) 76, 77, 159
crotchet 53, 55, 56, 59, 60
cut common time 59, 60
da capo (D.C.) 71
dal segno (D.S.) 71
degree names 93
diminished triad 113
diminuendo (dim.) 76
dolce 79, 81
dominant 116
dot 56, 57
duplet 65, 67
dynamics 76, 91
enharmonic 39, 41
fermata 82, 83, 91
Fine 71, 72, 173
first and second time bars 71
five-finger position 163
flat (♭) 39, 40, 41, 48
form 156, 157, 161
forte (f) 76
grand staff 27
hairpin 76
half pedal 85, 87
harmonic minor 96, 97
hemiola 68, 70
homophonic 152, 153
imitation 150
imperfect cadence 139, 140
interrupted cadence 139, 140
interval 42, 43, 48
inversion 119, 120, 131, 134
irregular time 62, 64
key 93, 94, 95, 97, 99
key signature 41, 99, 104, 108, 154
Largo 82
leading note 93, 116
ledger line 36, 37, 38, 48
legato 79, 81
major scale 93, 95, 145
major triad 113
melodic minor 96
metronome 50, 83, 165
metronome mark 50, 82, 83
mezzo (m) 76
Middle C 22, 24, 27, 28, 29
minim 53, 54, 55, 57, 59
minor scale 96
minor triad 113, 114
Moderato 82
modulation 154
monophonic 152
mood words 79, 81
mordent 88, 89
motif 148, 149, 161
natural (♮) 39, 41
octave 24, 38, 45, 48
ornament 88, 89, 91
pedal (sustain) 85, 86, 87, 91
perfect cadence 139, 140
performing 171, 172
phrase 148, 149, 159, 160, 161
phrase mark 79, 80
pianissimo (pp) 76
piano (p) 29, 76, 159, 171
plagal cadence 139

INDEX · CONTINUED

polyphonic 152
power chord 125, 126
practising 165
Presto 82
progression 144
pulse 50, 74
quaver 53, 56, 57, 59, 60
rallentando (rall.) 82, 83
relative minor 96, 99, 100, 154
repeat sign 51, 71, 72
rest 53, 54, 55, 61, 74
ritardando (rit.) 82, 83
Roman numerals 116
Romantic 156, 159, 160
rondo 156, 157
root 110, 114, 119, 120, 123
rubato 68, 70
scale 93, 95, 96, 108
semibreve 53, 54
semiquaver 53, 59, 66, 166
semitone 22, 39, 40, 42
sequence 150, 151
seventh chord 122, 134
sforzando (sfz) 76
sharp (♯) 39, 40, 41, 48
sight-reading 167
simple time 59, 60, 62
slash chord 131, 132
slur 79, 80, 91
sonata form 156, 157
sostenuto 85, 87
staccato 79, 91
staff 27, 28, 29, 36, 48
strophic 156
subdominant 116
sus chord 125, 134
swing 68
syncopation 68, 69
tempo 50, 51
tenuto 79
ternary form 156
texture 152, 153, 161
theme and variations 156
thumb under 163
tie 56, 57, 58
time signature 51, 52, 59, 60, 61
tone 22, 42
tonic 93, 116
treble clef 27
triad 110, 111, 113, 114
trill 88
triplet 65, 66, 67
turn 88, 91
twelve-bar blues 144, 145
two-note slur 79, 80
una corda (u.c.) 85
verse and chorus 156